

the value of the inventory required. We will only expand if the quality remains constant in terms of craftsmanship and the quality of stones," he says.

While that is true for individual designers, it is less of an issue for large corporates. Last year, Tanishq, a part of the Tata group, launched three stores in the US, located in Houston, San Francisco, and New Jersey, with another opening in Chicago this March. Kalyan Jewellers in the ongoing financial year aims to open two stores, one each in New Jersey and Chicago, while Chennai-based Vummidi Bangaru Jewellers plans to open three more outlets in the US, apart from its operational store in Frisco, near Dallas (Texas).

Corporates, too, want a share of the global red carpet. Zoya, a jewellery brand from the House of Tata, collaborated with designer Prabal Gurung for the Met Gala. British actress Simone Ashley wore his outfit and Zoya jewellery at the event.

For designers such as Farah Khan Ali, who set up her eponymous label—Farah Khan Fine Jewellery—in 2004 and has been a favourite of Bollywood stars such as Priyanka Chopra, Deepika Padukone, etc., expansion can happen through collaborations. Around a decade ago she collaborated with Tanishq for a couple of years and launched a collection made available exclusively at 40 stores across 23 cities. "It's the only way to reach a wider audience," she says. This was followed by a collaboration with CaratLane. Today her jewellery is available in Dubai and at Neiman Marcus in the US, besides her store in Mumbai. She launched her label Farah Khan Atelier in 2021. It is everyday jewellery in the ₹40,000-₹9 lakh price point and is available online. She also has six store-in-store concepts in India, including in Pune, Surat, Lucknow and Ahmedabad for Atelier. She is also looking at growth through a franchise model. "When we get the franchise model going, both couture jewellery and Atelier will be available through the franchise outlets," she explains, adding that she is in talks and hopes to find the right partners soon.

While Khan Ali may be looking at expansion, for Delhi-based jeweller Hanut Singh, who, for nearly two decades, has been redefining the jewellery landscape with creations that reflect his contemporary sensibilities and aesthetic vision, growth will happen at its own pace. "My journey has been very prolific, so let's see where it's headed now," says Singh. With his jewellery today being available in multi-brand boutiques at Paris, Lon-

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Farah Khan Ali, FOUNDER, FARAH KHAN FINE JEWELLERY



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ALL THAT GLITTERS

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